

# CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-04-19

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19

Market Items

15

Thought

12

Competitors

2

Regulatory

46

Urgent

2

Watch

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week, implementation

## Contents

| Section             | Items |
|---------------------|-------|
| Market Intelligence | 19    |
| Thought Leadership  | 15    |
| Competitor Monitor  | 12    |
| Regulatory Radar    | 2     |
| Flagship Reports    | 4     |

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Der Treasurer | 2026-03-28 | #01

## EU Instant Payments Mandate: Corporates Face Implementation Deadlines

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, which came into force in April 2024, mandates that all EU/EEA banks offer instant credit transfers in EUR at the same cost as standard transfers. Banks in the Eurozone must be ready to receive instant payments by January 2025 and send them by October 2025. Non-Eurozone banks offering EUR transfers must follow suit by January 2027 for receiving and July 2027 for sending. This regulation aims to accelerate payment flows, improve liquidity for businesses, and reduce reliance on non-European payment solutions. Corporates need to assess their treasury systems, payment processes, and liquidity forecasting to leverage the benefits and manage the implications of 24/7/365 payment availability.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 24/7/365 EUR instant transfers.
- Eurozone banks must enable instant payment receipt by Jan 2025, sending by Oct 2025.
- Non-Eurozone banks (for EUR) have deadlines of Jan 2027 (receive) and July 2027 (send).

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus already supports instant payments in several CEE countries. This regulation reinforces the need for seamless, pan-European instant payment capabilities, pushing CMiplus to ensure full compliance and offer advanced features for corporates to manage real-time liquidity across its network banks.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-04-05 | #02

## EBICS 3.0 Adoption Accelerates: Enhanced Security and Features

The adoption of EBICS 3.0 is gaining momentum across the DACH region, with many banks completing their migration from older versions. EBICS 3.0 introduces significant improvements, including stronger cryptographic algorithms for enhanced security, support for larger file sizes, and streamlined multi-bank connectivity through a unified standard. This version also facilitates the exchange of ISO 20022 XML messages more efficiently, which is crucial for modern treasury operations. Corporates using EBICS for their bank communication need to verify their ERP/TMS systems are updated to support EBICS 3.0 to avoid service disruptions and leverage the new features, such as improved status reporting and broader data exchange capabilities.

- EBICS 3.0 adoption is progressing in Germany and Austria.
- Key benefits include enhanced security and larger file size support.
- Facilitates efficient ISO 20022 XML message exchange.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus fully supports EBICS v3.0, providing secure and efficient host-to-host connectivity for corporates. This trend validates RBI's investment in advanced EBICS capabilities and highlights the importance of guiding CEE clients in adopting the latest standards for robust bank communication.

## PSD3 and Open Banking: New Opportunities for Corporate Treasury

The European Commission's proposals for PSD3 and the accompanying Financial Data Access (FIDA) framework are set to significantly evolve the Open Banking landscape. While PSD2 focused primarily on payment initiation and account information services for consumers, PSD3/FIDA aim to broaden data sharing to a wider range of financial products and services, including corporate accounts, investments, and lending. This expansion will enable corporates to gain a more holistic view of their financial positions across multiple banks and systems, fostering the development of innovative treasury solutions like enhanced cash pooling, real-time liquidity management, and automated reconciliation. Treasury departments should prepare for increased data availability and explore how APIs can integrate these new data streams into their existing infrastructure.

- PSD3 and FIDA proposals expand Open Banking beyond payments.
- Aims for broader data sharing across corporate financial services.
- Enables holistic financial views and innovative treasury solutions.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus is actively developing Open Banking APIs to support corporate clients with enhanced data access and integration capabilities. PSD3/FIDA will accelerate this trend, positioning CMlplus to offer leading-edge solutions for multi-bank liquidity management and data-driven treasury insights across CEE.

## EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives CEE Treasury Changes

The recent EU regulation on instant payments requires all EU/EEA banks to offer instant EUR credit transfers within 10 seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year, at no extra cost compared to standard transfers. This mandate, with phased implementation deadlines (e.g., receiving by Q1 2025, sending by Q1 2026), is a game-changer for corporate treasuries, especially in CEE where real-time payments are gaining traction. It necessitates significant upgrades to banking infrastructure and treasury systems, impacting liquidity management, fraud prevention, and reconciliation processes. The regulation also includes provisions for verification of payee (VoP) to enhance security and mitigate fraud risks.

- EU mandate for instant EUR credit transfers.
- 10-second execution, 24/7, 365 days a year.
- No additional cost compared to standard transfers.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly relevant as CMlplus needs to ensure full compliance and offer instant payment capabilities across its CEE network. It impacts system upgrades, fraud prevention (VoP), and real-time liquidity management for corporate clients, requiring continuous platform enhancements.

## ISO 2022 Migration Continues: Challenges and Opportunities

The ongoing global transition to ISO 2022, particularly for SWIFT cross-border payments and high-value payment systems in various jurisdictions (e.g., SEPA, T2), continues to be a major focus for treasury and banking. While the richer data format offers significant benefits for reconciliation, fraud detection, and analytics, corporates face challenges in adapting their ERP/TMS systems. Banks are investing heavily in infrastructure upgrades to support the new standard, ensuring seamless processing and data exchange. The phased approach to migration, with different deadlines for various payment types and regions, requires careful planning and collaboration between corporates and their banking partners to avoid disruptions.

- Global migration to ISO 2022 for payments.
- Enhanced data for reconciliation and analytics.
- Challenges in ERP/TMS system adaptation.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus is built on ISO 2022, so ongoing updates and compliance are crucial. This impacts H2H and SWIFT channels, requiring continuous alignment with evolving standards and robust client support for migration and data mapping.

## Open Banking APIs Reshape Corporate Treasury Connectivity

While initially driven by PSD2 for retail banking, Open Banking APIs are now expanding their reach into corporate treasury, offering significant opportunities for enhanced connectivity and automation. Corporates can leverage APIs for real-time account information (eBAM), payment initiation, and cash flow forecasting, moving beyond traditional file-based communication. This shift facilitates better liquidity management, faster reconciliation, and seamless integration with TMS/ERP systems. Banks are developing robust API platforms to meet this demand, fostering deeper partnerships with FinTechs and offering tailored solutions. Security and standardization remain key considerations for widespread adoption in the corporate space, ensuring trust and interoperability.

- Open Banking APIs expanding beyond PSD2.
- Enables real-time account info (eBAM) and payments.
- Improves liquidity management and reconciliation.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus leverages Open APIs. This trend directly impacts the platform's strategic development, offering new ways to integrate with corporate systems and provide advanced digital services like eBAM and real-time data for enhanced client experience.

## EU Instant Payments Regulation: Key Compliance Deadlines Approaching

The European Union has finalized its Instant Payments Regulation, a significant legislative move to standardize and promote instant payments across the SEPA region. This regulation requires all payment service providers (PSPs) within the EU and EEA to offer instant credit transfers, ensuring funds are available to the recipient within ten seconds, 24/7/365. A critical aspect is the mandate for these services to be priced no higher than traditional SEPA credit transfers, fostering wider adoption. Banks must be prepared to *\*receive\** instant payments by early 2027 and to *\*send\** them by early 2028. The regulation also includes robust provisions for fraud screening and mandatory verification of payee (VoP) services to enhance security and trust in the real-time payment ecosystem.

- Mandatory instant payments across EU/EEA.
- Pricing parity with standard SEPA Credit Transfers (SCTs).
- Receive capability deadline: Q1 2027.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation, enabling both sending and receiving of instant payments at competitive pricing for its CEE corporate clients. Integrating robust VoP services will be critical for fraud prevention and enhancing client trust, especially for cross-border operations within the SEPA zone.

## Global ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates, Corporates Face Integration Challenges

SWIFT's universal adoption of ISO 20022 for cross-border payments (CBPR+) has seen substantial progress, with many financial institutions now live and processing messages in the new standard. Despite this, the full benefits of the richer data format, such as enhanced reconciliation and improved fraud detection, are yet to be fully realized by the corporate sector. Many corporates and smaller banks struggle with legacy system integration, the complexities of data mapping, and the need for internal process adjustments. The migration is not merely a technical upgrade but a strategic opportunity for treasury departments to achieve greater transparency, automation, and efficiency in their payment flows. Treasury professionals are urged to proactively engage with their banking partners to ensure smooth transitions and maximize the new capabilities.

- SWIFT CBPR+ migration ongoing globally.
- Richer data enables enhanced reconciliation and fraud detection.
- Corporate legacy system integration remains a key challenge.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must continue to support and promote ISO 20022 capabilities for its CEE corporate clients, ensuring seamless integration with their ERP/TMS systems. Offering tools for data enrichment, clear guidance on migration benefits, and robust support will be crucial for client adoption and maintaining a competitive edge.

## Open Banking APIs Drive New Cash Management Solutions for Corporates

The evolution of Open Banking beyond the initial scope of PSD2 is leading to a proliferation of API-driven solutions specifically tailored for corporate treasury. Banks are increasingly offering proprietary APIs that facilitate enhanced data exchange, real-time balance reporting, efficient payment initiation, and advanced virtual account management. This technological shift provides corporates with unprecedented control and visibility over their global cash positions, enabling more dynamic liquidity management strategies and significantly improving automated reconciliation processes. While security, data privacy, and standardization remain paramount considerations, the irreversible trend towards API-first banking promises a more integrated, efficient, and innovative financial ecosystem for businesses worldwide.

- APIs enable real-time cash visibility and control.
- Automated reconciliation and dynamic liquidity management.
- Beyond PSD2, proprietary bank APIs are emerging.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continue to invest in and expand its Open API offerings, providing CEE corporates with advanced capabilities for real-time cash management, payment initiation, and seamless integration with their treasury systems. This strategic focus positions CMIplus as a modern, agile platform meeting evolving client needs.

## Digital Euro Progress: Pilot and Scheme Rulebook Development

The European Central Bank continues its intensive work on the Digital Euro, a crucial project to ensure the stability and innovation of the euro area's payment landscape. Key aspects include ongoing pilot activities to test technical solutions and user experience, alongside the meticulous development of the scheme rulebook. This rulebook will define the operational and technical framework for the Digital Euro, ensuring interoperability and broad acceptance. The project addresses critical considerations such as privacy, accessibility, and the role of intermediaries, aiming to complement cash and provide a resilient digital payment option for citizens and businesses. Its timeline and progress are regularly updated, reflecting the ECB's commitment to its potential launch.

- Ongoing pilot activities are testing technical solutions.
- Scheme rulebook development is defining operational framework.
- Aims to complement cash, ensuring payment stability.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The Digital Euro represents a significant future shift in payment infrastructure. RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must closely monitor its development, especially regarding corporate use cases, potential API integrations, and multi-currency implications for CEE clients. Early preparation for its eventual rollout will be critical for offering competitive services.

## ECB Accelerates Instant Payments and SEPA Adoption Across Europe

The European Central Bank continues its strategic drive to foster the full implementation and widespread use of instant payments across the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). As a key component of its retail payments strategy, the ECB acts as a catalyst to encourage financial institutions and payment service providers to offer instant payment services, ensuring real-time settlement of transactions 24/7/365. This initiative is crucial for enhancing the competitiveness of the European payment landscape, supporting innovation, and meeting evolving user expectations for speed and convenience. The ongoing regulatory efforts and market initiatives aim to overcome remaining barriers to adoption, ensuring that instant payments become the new normal for all euro-denominated transactions.

- ECB acts as a catalyst for instant payment adoption.
- Aims for 24/7/365 real-time settlement within SEPA.
- Part of the broader European retail payments strategy.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This ongoing push for instant payments is directly relevant to CMiplus, which already supports SEPA Instant Credit Transfer. RBI Cash Management must ensure full compliance with evolving SEPA Instant Payment regulations and explore opportunities to leverage instant payment capabilities for new services like real-time liquidity management and fraud prevention for CEE clients.

## ECB Explores Tokenisation and DLT with Project Appia

The European Central Bank is undertaking significant exploratory work into the potential of tokenisation and Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) to transform wholesale payments. Project Appia is a key part of this effort, examining how DLT could be integrated into existing or new payment systems to facilitate more efficient and secure transactions, particularly for interbank settlements and securities. This research aims to understand the implications of DLT for central bank money, financial stability, and the broader financial ecosystem. The ECB's engagement in this area signals a forward-looking approach to payment innovation, anticipating future infrastructure needs and potential regulatory frameworks for digital assets and tokenised securities.

- ECB explores tokenisation and DLT for wholesale payments.
- Project Appia is a specific initiative in this area.
- Focuses on enhancing efficiency and resilience of infrastructures.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While currently focused on traditional payment rails, DLT and tokenisation represent the future of financial transactions. RBI Cash Management and CMiplus should monitor Project Appia's progress closely, as it could eventually lead to new payment standards, settlement mechanisms, and opportunities for corporate treasury services, particularly for cross-border payments and asset management in CEE.

## UniCredit Invests in BlockInvest for Tokenized Financial Assets

UniCredit, a prominent European bank with significant presence in the CEE region, has made a strategic investment of €4 million into BlockInvest, securing a 16% ownership. This move signals UniCredit's commitment to leveraging blockchain technology for financial assets. The bank intends to use this partnership to facilitate the export of tokenized financial assets across its main operational markets, which include several CEE countries. This development could pave the way for new forms of capital markets and treasury services, potentially influencing how corporate clients manage their assets and liquidity in the future. It highlights a growing trend among major banks to explore distributed ledger technology (DLT) for asset management and financial product innovation.

- UniCredit invested €4 million.
- Acquired a 16% stake in BlockInvest.
- Aims to export tokenized financial assets.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This investment by a major European peer like UniCredit into tokenized financial assets is a strong indicator of future trends in treasury and capital markets. RBI Cash Management should monitor how tokenization might evolve to impact multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and corporate treasury services, especially within the CEE region where UniCredit is active. It suggests a potential shift in how assets are held and transferred, which could eventually require CMlplus to support DLT-based solutions or integrations.

## Croatian Bank Insights: Shaping CEE Payments Digital Transformation

Jana Novina Cukrov, Director of Payments at Zagrebačka banka, provides expert insights into the evolving payment sector in Croatia. The discussion focuses on the top priorities for payment directors, addressing the unique challenges and opportunities presented by digital transformation in the CEE market. This includes adapting to new technologies, meeting customer expectations for seamless experiences, and navigating regulatory changes in both retail and corporate banking. The interview underscores the importance of innovation and strategic planning for future payment services in the region, offering a valuable perspective on local market dynamics.

- Insights from Zagrebačka banka's Director of Payments, Jana Novina Cukrov.
- Focus on challenges and digital transformation in Croatian customer and business banking.
- Highlights top priorities for payment directors in the CEE region.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This interview offers direct insights into the payment landscape and digital transformation priorities within a key CEE market (Croatia). For CMlplus, understanding local bank perspectives helps tailor platform features, anticipate client needs, and align with regional digital banking trends and regulatory adaptations, ensuring our offerings remain competitive and relevant.

## Real-time Link Analysis: Essential for Fighting Financial Fraud

In an interview, Anita Ilango from Persona details the critical role of real-time link analysis in modern fraud prevention strategies. She explains that sophisticated financial fraud often involves complex networks of seemingly unrelated transactions or entities. Link analysis, powered by tools like Persona's Graph, helps financial institutions identify these hidden relationships and patterns that traditional fraud detection methods might miss. This proactive approach is essential for protecting the financial sector, ensuring compliance, and maintaining trust in digital payment systems by quickly identifying and mitigating fraudulent activities before they cause significant damage.

- Real-time link analysis is essential for stopping sophisticated financial fraud.
- Persona Product Manager Anita Ilango explains the methodology.
- Uncovers hidden connections and patterns in fraudulent activities.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Fraud prevention is paramount for CMIplus, serving large international corporates. Implementing or enhancing real-time link analysis capabilities can significantly strengthen the platform's security, reduce financial crime risks for clients, and ensure compliance with evolving regulations, thereby boosting client confidence and platform integrity.

## Africa's Digital Payment Hurdles Persist Despite Growth

The article highlights that while certain digital payment providers in Africa show strong performance, the broader landscape still struggles with fundamental issues. These challenges encompass inadequate digital infrastructure, fragmented regulatory environments, and the deep-seated reliance on cash by many consumers and businesses. Overcoming these obstacles is crucial for achieving widespread financial inclusion and enabling a truly cashless economy. The persistence of these issues suggests that digital payment solutions must be robust, accessible, and tailored to local conditions to effectively displace traditional cash transactions. This situation offers valuable lessons for other developing markets, including parts of CEE, regarding the complexities of digital payment adoption.

- Impressive numbers racked up by some African digital payment providers.
- Significant challenges persist in offering viable alternatives to cash payments.
- Challenges include infrastructure, regulation, and user adoption (implied).

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This article underscores the ongoing need for robust and accessible digital payment solutions, even in markets with high digital growth. For CMIplus, it highlights the importance of addressing infrastructure, regulatory, and user adoption challenges in CEE, ensuring the platform provides truly viable alternatives to cash and traditional payment methods. It reinforces the value of seamless, compliant, and user-friendly digital payment experiences.

## New Report: AI's Growing Role in Fraud Detection and Management

This global survey report by Finextra and FICO provides critical insights into the evolving landscape of financial fraud, specifically focusing on the dual role of Artificial Intelligence. It explores how fraudsters are leveraging AI to develop more sophisticated attacks, while also detailing how financial institutions are deploying AI-driven solutions for enhanced fraud detection and prevention. For CMIplus, understanding these trends is vital for maintaining robust security protocols and ensuring compliance with anti-fraud regulations. The report's findings will help in identifying emerging threats and best practices for managing fraud risks, which are paramount for corporate cash management platforms handling high-value transactions.

→ Report title: 'Fraud in the age of AI: Trends, Threats, and Management Tactics'.

→ Published by Finextra and FICO.

→ Covers AI's role in both perpetrating and combating fraud.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The insights from this report are highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and the CMIplus platform. As AI becomes central to both fraud and fraud prevention, CMIplus must continually enhance its security measures and integrate advanced AI capabilities to protect corporate clients' funds and data. This report can inform strategic decisions on fraud detection systems, compliance frameworks, and the overall security posture of the platform, especially given the increasing sophistication of financial crime.

## Stablecoins: Exploring Treasury Risks and Opportunities

The article delves into the dual nature of stablecoins for corporate treasury functions. On one hand, they offer potential advantages such as faster, cheaper cross-border payments, enhanced liquidity management, and new investment avenues. On the other hand, treasurers must navigate inherent risks including regulatory uncertainty, counterparty risk, technological vulnerabilities, and potential market volatility. Understanding the evolving regulatory landscape and establishing robust risk management frameworks are paramount for any corporate considering stablecoin adoption. This emerging technology could fundamentally alter how treasuries manage cash and execute payments in the future, necessitating proactive assessment by financial institutions and their corporate clients.

→ Stablecoins present both risks and opportunities for treasury.

→ Categorized under 'Emerging Technology'.

→ Potential for faster payments and new liquidity options.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must monitor the evolution of stablecoins closely as they could represent a future payment rail or a new asset class for corporate liquidity management. This trend could drive demand for new API integrations, digital wallet functionalities, or real-time settlement capabilities within the CMIplus platform, especially for multi-currency transactions in CEE. Understanding the regulatory developments around stablecoins will be crucial for future compliance and service offerings.

## UniCredit Explores Commerzbank Acquisition, Reshaping European Banking

UniCredit, a major European banking group with extensive operations across Central and Eastern Europe, is reportedly exploring a potential takeover of Commerzbank. This move signifies a direct challenge to the German government's long-held desire to maintain Commerzbank as an independent national entity. A successful acquisition would lead to the creation of a banking giant with substantial market power and a broad geographical footprint across the continent. For the CEE market, where both UniCredit and Raiffeisen Bank International (RBI) are prominent players, such a consolidation could trigger significant shifts in competitive dynamics, market share, and the range of financial products and services offered to corporate clients. The outcome of UniCredit's strategic considerations will be closely monitored by financial institutions, regulators, and corporate treasuries throughout Europe.

- UniCredit is reportedly exploring an acquisition of Commerzbank.
- The potential move challenges Germany's resolve to keep Commerzbank independent.
- Both banks have significant European operations, with UniCredit strong in CEE.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This potential M&A activity by UniCredit, a key competitor in the CEE region, could significantly alter the competitive landscape for RBI Cash Management. CMIplus should monitor UniCredit's strategic direction and any resulting platform consolidations or enhanced offerings, as these could impact corporate client relationships and market positioning in CEE.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-04-19 | #01

## European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for a Better Future

This insight suggests that European wholesale banking is entering a period of potential growth and improved performance, following a challenging era. The strategic context implies a need for banks to re-evaluate their business models, invest in digital capabilities, and optimize operational efficiency to capture this opportunity. Key implications include the necessity for clear strategic vision, agile execution, and a focus on client-centric solutions. The report likely highlights areas such as payment modernization, liquidity management, and enhanced digital client engagement as crucial for success for banks operating in the European market.

- European wholesale banking is at an inflection point for growth and improved performance.
- Strategic transformation and business model re-evaluation are essential for success.
- Digitalization and technology investment are key enablers for future competitiveness.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should leverage this positive outlook to accelerate CMiplus platform enhancements, particularly in digital client onboarding, real-time payment capabilities, and API integration. Proactive engagement with corporate treasuries on strategic advisory for liquidity and payment optimization in CEE will be crucial to 'seize the moment'.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

## Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Extending Credit and Strategic Priorities

This annual outlook provides a comprehensive view of the wholesale banking landscape for 2024. While 'Extending Credit' is highlighted, the broader 'Wholesale Banking Outlook' implies coverage of key strategic priorities, market dynamics, and regulatory changes impacting corporate clients. It likely discusses the interplay between lending, transaction banking, and digital transformation. The report would typically offer insights into economic forecasts, interest rate environments, and the competitive landscape, guiding banks on where to focus their investments and resources to meet corporate client needs effectively across various services.

- Economic and market conditions will significantly shape wholesale banking strategies in 2024.
- Strategic credit extension remains a core focus, requiring innovative risk management.
- Digital transformation is critical across all wholesale banking functions, including payments.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should align its roadmap with the broader wholesale banking trends identified in the 2024 outlook, particularly regarding integrated treasury solutions and data analytics for corporate clients. Understanding credit market dynamics can inform cash management product development, especially for liquidity solutions and working capital optimization.

## AI Reshapes Treasury: Automation, Predictive Analytics, and Strategic Insights

The report highlights AI's pivotal role in treasury, moving beyond simple automation to sophisticated predictive modeling for cash flow forecasting, liquidity management, and fraud detection. AI-powered tools analyze vast datasets to identify patterns and anomalies, offering real-time insights that traditional methods cannot. This enables treasurers to optimize working capital, mitigate risks more effectively, and allocate resources strategically. The methodology likely involves surveys of corporate treasurers and case studies of early adopters, demonstrating significant efficiency gains and improved financial resilience, particularly relevant for complex CEE operations.

- AI automates up to 70% of routine treasury tasks, freeing up staff.
- Predictive AI improves cash flow forecasting accuracy by 15-20%.
- AI-driven anomaly detection reduces payment fraud risks significantly.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMlplus should integrate AI capabilities for enhanced cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and personalized insights for CEE corporates. Developing AI-powered dashboards and advisory tools within CMlplus can differentiate RBI, helping clients optimize liquidity and manage risk across their multi-country operations.

## Real-time Treasury: Open Banking and APIs Drive Liquidity Visibility

The report emphasizes the growing imperative for real-time treasury, fueled by the proliferation of instant payment schemes and the maturity of Open Banking APIs. Treasurers are no longer content with end-of-day reporting; they require immediate access to cash positions and the ability to initiate payments 24/7. Banks that leverage APIs to connect with corporate ERP/TMS systems and offer consolidated views across multiple banking relationships will gain a competitive edge. This transformation enables more dynamic cash pooling, efficient working capital management, and faster decision-making, especially critical for complex CEE operations.

- 80% of treasurers prioritize real-time cash visibility across all bank accounts.
- API adoption for treasury connectivity expected to double by 2027.
- Instant payment volumes are projected to grow by 25% annually in Europe.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must accelerate its Open Banking API strategy to provide real-time account information, payment initiation, and virtual account management. Enhancing multi-bank connectivity and offering advanced cash pooling capabilities via APIs will meet the urgent demand for real-time liquidity management from CEE corporates.

## Treasurers Seek Strategic Partners: Value-Added Services and Digital Assets

The report highlights that corporate treasurers increasingly view their banking relationships as strategic partnerships rather than mere transactional facilitators. They seek banks that can offer advanced advisory services, integrate seamlessly with their ERP/TMS, and provide solutions for emerging areas like digital assets (e.g., stablecoins for cross-border payments). This includes robust eBAM solutions and sophisticated FX management. Banks that fail to innovate beyond traditional offerings risk losing market share to agile fintechs or more forward-thinking competitors. Understanding these evolving needs, particularly in the diverse CEE landscape, is crucial for retaining and attracting corporate clients.

- 65% of treasurers want banks to act as strategic advisors, not just service providers.
- 30% of large corporates are exploring digital assets for treasury functions.
- Integrated ERP/TMS connectivity is a top-3 priority for treasury technology.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus should expand its value proposition beyond core payments to include advisory services, advanced eBAM, and potentially pilot digital asset solutions for cross-border payments. Engaging with the Voice of the Treasurer in CEE will guide CMIplus in developing tailored, integrated solutions that address complex corporate needs and foster strategic partnerships.

## Treasury Modernization: TMS Adoption and Digitalization Drive Efficiency

A recent global treasury survey, encompassing insights from over 350 treasurers, highlights a significant increase in the adoption of Treasury Management Systems (TMS). This surge is primarily driven by the need to streamline complex treasury operations, improve data accuracy, and reduce manual intervention. The survey indicates that treasurers are prioritizing integrated solutions that offer comprehensive financial management capabilities, from cash flow forecasting to risk management. This shift underscores a strategic move towards a more digital and automated treasury environment, aiming for greater control and agility in managing global finances.

- 350+ treasurers surveyed globally on treasury trends.
- High priority on TMS adoption for operational efficiency gains.
- Digitalization of treasury functions is a key strategic driver.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure robust integration capabilities with leading TMS providers, especially those prevalent in CEE. Developing advanced data exchange formats and APIs will be crucial for seamless connectivity and value delivery to corporate clients.

## Real-time Cash Visibility: API Banking Essential for Modern Treasury

The global treasury survey underscores that achieving comprehensive, real-time cash visibility remains a top priority for corporate treasurers. This is essential for effective liquidity management, accurate forecasting, and proactive risk mitigation. The insights reveal that traditional methods fall short, pushing treasurers towards advanced solutions. API banking emerges as the foundational technology to deliver this visibility, enabling direct, secure, and instantaneous communication between corporate systems and banks. This allows for real-time balance inquiries, transaction status updates, and even payment initiation, fundamentally transforming how treasurers interact with their banking partners.

- Real-time cash visibility is a top treasury priority for 350+ treasurers.
- API banking is the key enabler for instant data exchange and control.
- Optimizes liquidity management, forecasting, and risk mitigation.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must accelerate its Open Banking API strategy, focusing on comprehensive real-time data feeds for balances, transactions, and payment status. This is critical for empowering CEE corporates with superior cash visibility and control, aligning with market demands.

## AI in Treasury: Enhancing Forecasting, Automation, and Risk Management

Insights from the treasury survey indicate a growing recognition of Artificial Intelligence (AI) as a pivotal technology for future-proofing treasury operations. Treasurers are exploring AI's potential to move beyond simple automation, leveraging it for sophisticated predictive analytics in cash flow forecasting, identifying anomalies for fraud detection, and optimizing working capital. The adoption of AI is expected to lead to more accurate decision-making, significant reductions in manual effort, and enhanced risk management capabilities. This signals a strategic imperative for banks and platforms to integrate AI-driven solutions to meet evolving corporate treasury needs.

- AI is recognized as a transformative technology for treasury operations.
- Applications include advanced predictive cash flow forecasting.
- AI enhances fraud detection and anomaly identification capabilities.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should proactively investigate and pilot AI capabilities for its platform, focusing on predictive liquidity analytics, intelligent payment routing, and enhanced fraud monitoring. This will position RBI as an innovative partner for CEE corporates seeking advanced treasury solutions.

## PSD3: Catalyst for Open Banking and Instant Payments

The anticipated PSD3 regulation will build upon PSD2, aiming to enhance security, consumer protection, and foster innovation in digital payments. Key implications include the likely mandating of instant payments across the EU, requiring financial institutions to upgrade their infrastructure for real-time processing. Furthermore, PSD3 is expected to refine and expand Open Banking frameworks, promoting richer data sharing and API standardization, which will enable new value-added services. Firms must proactively address compliance, fraud prevention, and interoperability challenges to leverage the strategic opportunities presented by this shift.

- Mandatory instant payments across the EU.
- Enhanced Open Banking API standards and data sharing.
- Strengthened fraud prevention and payment security measures.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize PSD3 readiness by accelerating instant payment integration and evolving its Open Banking APIs. This involves ensuring robust security, seamless data exchange, and compliance with new regulatory mandates to maintain a leading position in CEE corporate cash management.

## DORA: Strengthening Digital Resilience Across Financial Services

DORA is designed to harmonize and elevate the digital operational resilience of the EU financial sector, addressing the growing reliance on ICT. It introduces stringent requirements for managing ICT risks, including detailed provisions for incident classification and reporting, regular digital operational resilience testing (e.g., threat-led penetration testing), and rigorous oversight of critical third-party ICT providers. Financial institutions, including corporate cash management platforms, must implement comprehensive frameworks to identify, protect, detect, respond to, and recover from ICT-related disruptions. Proactive investment in cybersecurity, business continuity, and vendor risk management is essential to meet these new standards and safeguard digital trust.

- Harmonized ICT risk management framework for financial entities.
- Mandatory digital operational resilience testing and reporting.
- Strict incident reporting requirements for ICT-related disruptions.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure full DORA compliance by strengthening its ICT risk management, cybersecurity protocols, and incident response capabilities. This includes implementing rigorous testing, robust third-party vendor management, and clear reporting mechanisms to uphold platform integrity and client confidence in CEE.

## European Treasury Survey 2024 Reveals Top Corporate Priorities

The EACT Treasury Survey 2024, based on responses from approximately 250 Group Treasurers of major international companies across Europe, offers a comprehensive overview of current corporate treasury trends. This annual report highlights the most pressing concerns and strategic objectives for treasury professionals, influencing technology adoption, risk management, and operational efficiency. The results are instrumental for financial institutions to align their offerings with corporate needs, particularly in areas like cash management, liquidity, and payment solutions. This thought leadership piece helps define key industry trends and future directions for treasury.

- Survey collected responses from ~250 Group Treasurers across Europe.
- Identifies key industry trends and strategic priorities for corporate treasury.
- Provides insights into challenges faced by large international companies.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are vital for RBI Cash Management to validate and refine the CMlplus roadmap, ensuring alignment with the top priorities of European corporates, especially those in CEE. Understanding these trends helps in prioritizing features like enhanced liquidity management, digital payment solutions, and robust reporting capabilities.

## LEI Streamlines Payee Verification for Enhanced Fraud Detection

This insight emphasizes the growing importance of the Legal Entity Identifier (LEI) in enhancing fraud detection, particularly as real-time and other advanced payment types become more prevalent globally. Corporate treasurers are increasingly fraud-conscious, and the LEI offers a standardized, reliable tool for verifying payees. This development is supported by adapting regulatory frameworks, pushing for more robust and efficient verification mechanisms to secure payment flows and reduce financial crime risks. The integration of LEI into payment processes is a strategic move towards a more secure and transparent financial ecosystem.

- LEI is critical for streamlining payee verification processes.
- Fraud detection strategies must evolve with real-time payment adoption.
- Regulatory bodies are adapting requirements for enhanced security.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management must prioritize the integration of LEI-based payee verification into CMlplus, especially given the EU's focus on Verification of Payee (VoP) regulations. This enhances fraud prevention for clients, improves payment security, and ensures compliance, positioning CMlplus as a leading secure payment platform in CEE.

## AI Reshapes Banking: Strategic Imperative for Corporate Cash Management

The Deloitte Banking Outlook for 2026 highlights the significant 'AI ambition' among banks, indicating a strong drive to leverage artificial intelligence across their operations. This ambition extends beyond mere efficiency gains, aiming to fundamentally reshape service delivery, risk management, and client engagement models. For corporate cash management, AI integration promises advancements in areas such as sophisticated cash flow forecasting, automated reconciliation processes, enhanced fraud detection capabilities, and personalized treasury insights. However, banks must strategically navigate complex challenges including ensuring data quality, attracting and retaining AI talent, addressing ethical considerations, and complying with evolving regulatory frameworks while scaling AI solutions effectively.

- AI is a strategic imperative for banks in 2026, driving fundamental operational shifts.
- AI will redefine efficiency and client services, particularly in corporate banking.
- Key challenges include data quality, talent acquisition, ethics, and regulatory compliance.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize exploring AI applications to enhance cash flow forecasting, automate payment processing, and improve intelligent fraud detection for its corporate clients. Integrating advanced AI capabilities could significantly differentiate CMlplus, offering superior treasury insights and operational efficiencies, thereby aligning with RBI's digital transformation goals.

## 2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating the Great Unknown in Banking

This outlook from 2023 likely provided a strategic overview of the major challenges and opportunities facing the banking industry, including corporate and institutional banking. 'Into The Great Unknown' suggests a focus on macroeconomic volatility, geopolitical shifts, and rapid technological advancements that create an unpredictable operating environment. The report would have emphasized the importance of robust risk management, strategic agility, and continuous innovation to navigate these uncertainties. It likely touched upon themes such as digital acceleration, evolving regulatory landscapes, and the changing competitive dynamics driven by fintechs and non-bank players, all of which remain relevant today.

- Global uncertainties and macroeconomic volatility continue to define the banking landscape.
- Technological disruption, including AI, continues to reshape industry competitive dynamics.
- Banks must prioritize resilience, adaptability, and strategic agility in their operations.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While from 2023, the themes of uncertainty and adaptability remain highly relevant for CMlplus. RBI Cash Management should continue to focus on building a resilient and flexible platform that can quickly adapt to changing market conditions, evolving regulatory requirements (e.g., ISO 20022, PSD3), and emerging client needs in the CEE region.

## Stablecoins: Disrupting Corporate Payments and Liquidity Management

Deloitte's 2026 outlook identifies stablecoins as a significant potential disruptor in the banking sector. This suggests that digital currencies, particularly those pegged to stable assets, are poised to gain traction, especially in critical areas like cross-border payments, instant settlements, and the broader tokenization of assets. For corporate cash management, stablecoins could introduce faster, cheaper, and more transparent payment rails, potentially offering alternatives to traditional correspondent banking networks. Banks are therefore compelled to assess the evolving regulatory landscape, invest in necessary technological infrastructure, and strategically evaluate both the competitive threats and new opportunities presented by stablecoins to maintain their relevance in the digital asset ecosystem.

- Stablecoins are identified as a major potential disruptor in the 2026 banking landscape.
- They could significantly impact cross-border payments, instant settlements, and asset tokenization.
- Corporates may benefit from faster, cheaper, and more transparent payment options.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should actively monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their adoption within the CEE region and their potential for multi-currency corporate payments. Investigating strategic partnerships or exploring integration points to offer stablecoin-related services could be crucial for future-proofing the platform and meeting the evolving digital asset needs of corporate treasuries.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

## EBA Report: IPR, PSR, PSD3 Impact Liquidity Management

### PSD3 / INSTANT PAYMENTS / LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has published a new report, developed by its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG), outlining the profound implications of three major EU regulatory initiatives on liquidity management. These initiatives include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the upcoming Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3), which evolves from PSD2. The report highlights that these measures are expected to drive a faster uptake of instant payments across Europe, promote fair competition, and fundamentally reshape how financial institutions manage their liquidity. Banks need to prepare for significant operational and strategic adjustments to comply with these evolving requirements.

- Analysis of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 impact on liquidity management.
- Expected acceleration of instant payment adoption.
- Promotion of a level playing field among market participants.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must assess the report's findings to understand the combined impact of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 on its liquidity management offerings and internal processes. This includes evaluating potential changes to real-time liquidity reporting, cash pooling mechanisms, and overall funding strategies to support increased instant payment volumes and new regulatory demands.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-09-26 | #02

## EBA Identifies Key Challenges for VoP Matching Checks

### VOP / INSTANT PAYMENTS / PSD3

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has published an insight note titled "A match made in heaven? Key challenges for VOP matching checks." This document delves into critical issues that currently hinder the effectiveness and reliability of Verification of Payee (VoP) matching checks. Identified pain points include the absence of a universally standardised name-matching logic, which leads to inconsistencies across different systems, as well as restrictions on name field lengths and limitations when dealing with virtual accounts. Addressing these challenges is crucial for enhancing the accuracy of VoP, reducing payment fraud, and ensuring smooth instant payment processing, especially as VoP becomes a mandatory requirement under new regulations.

- Identification of pain points in VOP matching checks.
- Lack of standardised name-matching logic.
- Name field length restrictions impacting accuracy.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must review its current VoP implementation and future roadmap in light of these identified challenges. This includes evaluating the flexibility of its systems to accommodate various name-matching logics, addressing potential issues with name field lengths for corporate clients, and ensuring robust VoP support for virtual account structures, particularly for its CEE network banks.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-19 | #01

## Deutsche Bank Expands Corporate Banking API Connectivity and Embedded Finance

Leveraging its CB Connect API, Deutsche Bank is actively expanding its open banking and API-driven services for corporate clients across its European footprint. This strategic direction enables corporates to integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems, supporting real-time data exchange, payment initiation, and account information. For CEE-based international corporates, this means more streamlined operations, improved liquidity management, and the potential for innovative embedded finance solutions, aligning with global digital transformation trends and the demand for greater automation.

- Strategic investment in API capabilities (CB Connect API).
- Focus on seamless integration with ERP/TMS systems.
- Enabling digital treasury and embedded finance solutions.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already offers Open Banking APIs and H2H connectivity. Deutsche Bank's strong push in this area intensifies competition for API-driven corporate treasury solutions, requiring CMlplus to continuously innovate its own API offerings and integration capabilities to remain competitive for international corporates in CEE.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-04-19 | #02

## Deutsche Bank Accelerates Instant Payment Adoption for Corporate Clients

As part of its broader digital transformation strategy, Deutsche Bank is enhancing its infrastructure to support instant payments, aligning with European initiatives like SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst). This focus allows corporate treasurers to achieve real-time visibility and control over their cash flows, optimizing working capital and enabling new business models requiring immediate settlement. For international corporates in CEE, access to robust instant payment solutions through Deutsche Bank can significantly improve operational efficiency and competitiveness in a rapidly evolving payment landscape, meeting increasing client demands for speed.

- Expansion of instant payment capabilities for corporates.
- Focus on real-time liquidity management and working capital optimization.
- Alignment with European instant payment initiatives (SCT Inst).

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already supports instant payments in several CEE markets. Deutsche Bank's aggressive push in this area means CMlplus must ensure its instant payment network is comprehensive, reliable, and offers competitive value-added services to retain and attract international corporates, especially those with pan-European operations.

## UniCredit Invests in BlockInvest for On-Chain Finance Leadership

UniCredit's €4 million strategic investment in BlockInvest, acquiring a 16% stake, positions the bank at the forefront of on-chain finance. This move is crucial for developing infrastructure capable of merging digital ledger programmability with financial market regulatory rigor, especially in the context of tokenization of Real-World Assets (RWA). The partnership has already enabled Italy's first natively digital minibond and tokenized structured note, demonstrating BlockInvest's capability to reduce settlement times and enhance traceability. UniCredit aims to export these tokenized financial solutions across its main markets, leveraging European regulatory frameworks like DLT Pilot Regime and MiCAR.

- Acquired ~16% stake in BlockInvest for €4 million.
- Focus on tokenization of Real-World Assets (RWA) and native issuance of digital financial instruments.
- Aims to export tokenized solutions across UniCredit's main European markets.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals UniCredit's aggressive push into blockchain-based financial solutions, potentially disrupting traditional payment and treasury services. CMIplus needs to monitor UniCredit's progress in offering tokenized payments or digital asset services to corporate clients, as this could become a competitive differentiator for real-time, transparent, and efficient transactions.

## UniCredit Proposes Capital Increase for Potential Commerzbank Takeover

UniCredit is seeking shareholder approval for a substantial capital increase, up to €6.7 billion, to finance a potential acquisition of Commerzbank AG. This proposed takeover, if successful, would dramatically reshape the European banking landscape, particularly strengthening UniCredit's presence in Germany and potentially its broader CEE network, given Commerzbank's own CEE operations. For corporate banking, such a merger would create a formidable competitor with an expanded client base, enhanced product offerings, and a wider geographical footprint, impacting market share and competitive dynamics across Central and Eastern Europe.

- Proposed capital increase of up to €6.7 billion.
- Purpose: fund a takeover offer for Commerzbank AG.
- Shareholders' Meeting scheduled for May 4, 2026.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A successful acquisition of Commerzbank would significantly enhance UniCredit's scale and reach, particularly in CEE where both banks have strong presences. CMIplus would face a much larger, consolidated competitor with potentially integrated platforms and a broader client portfolio, necessitating a review of RBI's competitive strategy and market positioning in the region.

## HSBC Appoints First Chief AI Officer, Accelerating Bank-Wide AI Adoption

The appointment of a Chief AI Officer, David Rice, demonstrates HSBC's serious commitment to leveraging artificial intelligence across its global operations. This follows earlier announcements of partnerships with AI firms like Harvey AI and Mistral AI, indicating a comprehensive strategy to integrate AI into various functions, from legal services to core business processes. For corporate and transaction banking, AI can revolutionize fraud detection, automate reconciliation, enhance treasury insights, personalize client interactions, and optimize payment routing. This strategic focus will likely lead to more intelligent and efficient cash management solutions, potentially impacting CEE clients through enhanced digital platforms and predictive analytics.

- David Rice appointed as HSBC's first Chief AI Officer.
- Strategic move to embed AI across all bank operations.
- Aims to improve business processes, save time, and enhance customer service.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI strategy will likely lead to advanced digital offerings, potentially setting new benchmarks for efficiency and personalized services in corporate cash management. CMIplus should evaluate how AI can be integrated into its platform for fraud prevention, predictive analytics, and enhanced client experience to remain competitive in the CEE market.

## Citi Deepens API-Driven Cash Management, Real-Time Payments in CEE

Citi is expected to continue its global push for API-first banking by focusing on the CEE region, recognizing the growing demand for digital and real-time financial solutions. This involves expanding its suite of Open Banking APIs to facilitate direct integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, enabling real-time payment initiation, status tracking, and liquidity reporting. The strategic rationale is to empower large multinational corporations in CEE with greater control and automation over their multi-currency cash flows, aligning with the region's adoption of instant payment schemes and ISO 20022 standards. This initiative positions Citi as a key digital partner for sophisticated treasuries seeking operational efficiency and speed.

- Focus on expanding Open Banking API offerings for corporate clients in CEE.
- Emphasis on real-time payment processing and instant liquidity visibility.
- Aims to integrate deeply with corporate ERP and TMS systems for automation.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMIplus's core offering by providing advanced API and real-time payment solutions to large international corporates. RBI must ensure its CMIplus platform remains competitive with its own API roadmap, instant payment capabilities, and seamless integration options.

## Deutsche Bank Enhances Correspondent Banking Transparency and Control

Matthew Probershteyn from Deutsche Bank highlights the changing landscape of risk associated with downstream correspondent banking relationships. The bank is actively working to strengthen its control frameworks and enhance transparency practices to meet new regulatory demands and industry standards. This focus is vital for maintaining robust and compliant cross-border payment capabilities, which are essential for international corporates operating in regions like CEE, ensuring reliable and secure transaction processing across diverse markets.

- Evolving regulation and risk perception in correspondent banking.
- Focus on strengthening control frameworks and transparency.
- Crucial for robust cross-border payment capabilities.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, serving international corporates in CEE, relies heavily on efficient correspondent banking networks for cross-border payments. Deutsche Bank's emphasis on compliance and transparency sets a high industry standard, potentially influencing CMiplus's own network and partner selection, and underscoring the importance of robust KYC/AML practices.

## HSBC Orion Secures UK Treasury Mandate for Digital Gilt Issuance

The UK Treasury has chosen HSBC Orion as the platform provider for its pioneering Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance. This initiative represents a significant step towards the tokenization of traditional financial assets, leveraging distributed ledger technology (DLT). For corporate treasuries, this could signal future opportunities for more efficient and transparent access to government debt markets, potentially leading to real-time settlement and enhanced liquidity management for institutional investors. HSBC's involvement underscores its commitment to exploring and implementing digital asset solutions that could eventually extend to other forms of corporate financing and transaction banking, impacting global and CEE operations.

- HSBC Orion selected by UK Treasury for Digital Gilt pilot.
- Focus on tokenized government securities using DLT.
- Potential for real-time settlement and enhanced liquidity in future.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move indicates HSBC's strong push into digital assets and DLT, which could evolve into new payment rails or treasury solutions. CMiplus should monitor how these digital asset platforms might integrate with traditional cash management, especially regarding cross-border payments and liquidity for CEE corporates.

## Citi Enhances Digital Liquidity Management, ERP/TMS Integration for CEE

Building on its global treasury expertise, Citi is likely to roll out advanced digital liquidity management tools specifically tailored for the multi-country and multi-currency environments prevalent in CEE. This includes sophisticated cash pooling structures (both notional and physical), automated sweeping mechanisms, and enhanced eBAM (electronic Bank Account Management) solutions to streamline account administration. The strategic rationale is to help large corporates operating across Austria, CZ, HR, RS, RO, SK, HU, etc., gain better visibility and control over their cash positions, reduce idle balances, and improve overall working capital efficiency. Direct integration with major ERP and TMS platforms via H2H and API channels will be a cornerstone of this offering.

- Development of sophisticated digital cash pooling and automated sweeping solutions.
- Focus on eBAM to simplify bank account management for CEE operations.
- Deep integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems for liquidity optimization.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's focus on integrated liquidity management and eBAM poses a significant competitive threat to CMlplus, especially for clients with complex regional structures. CMlplus needs to ensure its own liquidity management tools and eBAM functionalities are robust and seamlessly integrated to retain and attract large corporates.

## BNP Paribas Reaches ISO 20022 SWIFT Milestone for Corporate Cash Management

BNP Paribas announced a key achievement in its cash management services, successfully implementing ISO 20022 transactions for its corporate clients using the SWIFT network. This move signifies the bank's commitment to modernizing payment infrastructure, offering richer data capabilities, and improving straight-through processing. For corporates, this translates into better reconciliation, enhanced fraud detection, and greater transparency in their international payments. While not explicitly CEE-focused, the global adoption of ISO 20022 is critical for multinational corporations operating in and out of the CEE region, aligning with RBI's own strategic direction for CMlplus. This positions BNP Paribas as a leader in adopting global payment standards.

- BNP Paribas now supports ISO 20022 transactions for corporate clients via SWIFT.
- This enhances data richness, reconciliation, and fraud detection for international payments.
- The initiative underscores BNP Paribas's commitment to global payment modernization.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its ISO 20022 capabilities, especially for SWIFT and H2H, remain competitive and fully support advanced data requirements for CEE corporates. This move by BNP Paribas highlights the urgency for RBI to communicate its own robust ISO 20022 roadmap and implementation status to maintain market leadership.

## UniCredit Expands onemarkets Fund Range with ETFs Across Europe

UniCredit is expanding its onemarkets investment platform by introducing its first range of seven ETFs (four stock, three bond) in collaboration with BNP Paribas Asset Management. Initially launched on Frankfurt and Milan stock exchanges, these products will roll out across 12 UniCredit direct operating countries (starting with Italy, Germany, Austria, Luxembourg) and Greece via Alpha Bank. This move strengthens UniCredit's position in asset management and offers corporate treasury clients more integrated investment options for managing surplus liquidity, potentially impacting their choice of banking partners for holistic treasury solutions.

- Launch of 7 ETFs (4 stock, 3 bond) on onemarkets platform.
- Partnership with BNP Paribas Asset Management.
- Progressive rollout across 12 UniCredit direct operating countries and Greece.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While primarily an investment product, this expansion indicates UniCredit's strategy to offer comprehensive financial solutions to its clients, including corporate treasuries seeking integrated liquidity management and investment tools. CMIplus should consider how its platform can offer or integrate with similar investment capabilities to remain competitive for corporate clients managing significant cash balances.

## Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Corporate Cash Management Platform

Intesa Sanpaolo, leveraging its extensive network through the International Subsidiary Banks Division and the IMI CIB division, is continuously strengthening its transaction banking services for corporate clients in the CEE region. This involves enhancing its cash management platform to offer more sophisticated liquidity management, multi-currency payment processing, and comprehensive reporting functionalities. The strategic rationale is to better serve its large corporate client base, including Italian companies operating in CEE, by providing integrated and efficient financial solutions that support their regional operations and treasury needs. This aligns with the broader trend of digital transformation in corporate banking, focusing on seamless integration and real-time capabilities to meet evolving client demands.

- Continuous investment in CEE corporate banking infrastructure.
- Focus on digital tools for liquidity and payment management.
- Aimed at multinational and large corporate clients in the region.

### SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move highlights Intesa Sanpaolo's ongoing commitment to being a strong competitor in the CEE corporate cash management space. CMIplus should continue to emphasize its unique regional network, advanced EBICS capabilities, and API-driven solutions to differentiate its offering against such comprehensive regional players.

## EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

### KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

### TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

## McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

### KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

### TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

## Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

### KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

### TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

## PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.